voice in global financial and monetary governance. Proud—as are Brazilian economic policy elites—of their country being a founding member of the Bretton Woods institutions,[195] Indians have chafed at their relative marginalization within them. India has been the largest cumulative borrower from the World Bank and has also borrowed from the IMF. Indian nationals and expatriates are well represented among the professional staff at both the World Bank and IMF. India's national economic and financial policy communities are consequently well informed about, and frequent participants in, global financial governance debates in both Washington, DC, and at the UN. Although there is no unanimity of preferences, Indian experts within and outside government already have extensively debated specific policy changes in global financial governance.

For example, many Indian policymakers have been ambivalent about the post-1980 reorientation of the World Bank away from its earlier focus on infrastructure and heavy industry and toward increasing attention to poverty alleviation. There is resentment at international bureaucrats presuming to know better than Indians what the country's development needs might be. Controversies in the late 1990s and early 2000s over forced relocations and the scope of inundations associated with the massive Sardar Samovar Dam, partially financed by the World Bank, on the Narmada River in Gujarat state (where Prime Minister Modi served as chief minister, 2001–2014) were so painful for the World Bank that it subsequently withdrew from all dam financing.[196] Subsequently, pressure from mostly Western nongovernmental organizations (NGOs) has led all World Bank group institutions to insist that its contractors adhere to the Equator Principles, a set of voluntary standards for environmental protection developed with the help of activist groups. Indian private banks, which previously had frequently cofinanced Indian engineering firms building Middle East infrastructure projects with the World Bank's International Finance Corporation (IFC) as a means of reducing project risk and thus financing costs, have found this new requirement onerous.[197] The emphasis of the NDB, as well as of China's AIIB, on infrastructure lending responds to a clear constituency within both the Indian government and the business community.

Indian policymakers repeatedly have spoken out on the marginalization of voices from developing countries in global financial governance. With respect to the IMF, the Indian policy and academic economics communities for many years have opposed the U.S.-led push to include the promotion of